aptly. The lounge suit worn by the Quaid in his portrait hanging in the National Assembly was painted into an 'achkan' (Pakistan's National dress) to give it a nationalist look. As Z.A. Sulehri, the Editor of Pakistan Times and staunch nationalist, commented, 'Paint the Quaid as he is' (Nizami, 2010). Thus, this marriage of convenience between the political forces and the rhetoric of Islam as the basis of the creation of Pakistan laid the foundations for the beginning of Islamic extremism and radicalisation in Pakistan.

The military dictator General Musharraf was the other ruler of Pakistan from 1999 to 2008, who posed a secular face but relied on religious elements and Islamic rhetoric to strengthen his rule.

Islamic extremism and subsequently terrorism bloomed and transformed into full-fledged terrorism in the eras of military dictatorships of General Zia-ul-Haq (1977–89) and General Pervez Musharraf (1999–2008). Both grabbed the opportunities arising from the crises in Afghanistan and secured US support to rule with impunity and keep democracy at bay in return to help the US achieve its objectives to contain communism in 1979 and bridle Taliban and Al Qaeda in 2001 in Afghanistan, respectively. The former created Mujahedeen with the money provided by the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) to fight the Soviet forces in Afghanistan and the latter fiddled with Taliban, Al Qaeda and home-grown Taliban until they became uncontrollable and an existential threat to Pakistan and a grave danger to the world.

During General Zia-ul-Haq's regime, Pakistan's headlong involvement in Afghanistan gave the Islamic extremists a rallying point and a training field. A large number of Muslim zealots from around the world were attracted to participate in the jihad against the infidel invader. According to a report, 35,000 holy warriors joined the Afghan war from 1979 to 1989 (Rashid, 1999). They could not remain restricted only to that border. Axiomatically, when jihad was at its peak in Afghanistan, Kashmir could not remain ignored. It has been the bone of contention and a powder keg since the partition of the sub-continent.

Pakistan and India had already fought three wars mainly due to the Kashmir dispute. Both the countries claimed it. Pakistan considered Kashmir as its 'jugular vein', and India regarded it as its 'inseparable part'. A brief background of this dispute can shed light on the seriousness of its genesis.